FLY RANK ORGANIZATION

MACHINE LEARNING INTERNSHIP

JULY- ML INTERN

DNS Walkthrough — How My Site Gets Found

What a CNAME record is

Think of a website's real address like a phone number that keeps changing. A CNAME record is like a sticky note that says "don't call this number, call this other number instead." Instead of my subdomain having its own address, it just points to another name. If that other address ever changes, I don't have to update anything — the sticky note still points to the right place.

What value mine will hold

Once FlyRank's team creates my subdomain (`yourname.flyrank.ai`), it will hold a note pointing to my Netlify address: `sakhawat-portfolio.netlify.app`. One name pointing to another name — nothing more complicated than that.

What happens when someone types my address

Say someone types `yourname.flyrank.ai` into their browser. Here's what happens, step by step, like trying to call a friend when you only know their name, not their number:

1. The browser asks a **resolver** — basically an operator — "what's the number for this name?"
2. The resolver doesn't know off the top of its head, so it checks a **nameserver** (like flipping through the right phone book) until it finds the answer for `flyrank.ai`.
3. The nameserver replies: "that name is actually just pointing to another name — go check that one" (that's the CNAME).
4. The resolver looks up that other name and finally gets the real number (the IP address).
5. The resolver hands that number back to the browser.
6. The browser connects to that number, asks for the page, and the site sends it back — with a padlock (HTTPS) showing it's safe.

All of this happens in under a second, every time someone visits.

Why I'm writing this now, before I need it

When the subdomain is actually granted, I won't be learning any of this under pressure — I'll just follow it like a checklist: confirm the CNAME is set, add the custom domain in Netlify, wait for it to activate, and check for the padlock. The site itself doesn't change — the domain is just a new pointer to the exact same place.